

you better performance and the ability to run programs meant for one device on an entirely different device.

This has to be the best thing ever, right? Not really. As awesome as emulators sound, they too have a few complications. For instance, an emulator often needs more processing power than the device or software it is emulating. Hence, better hardware. It can also, at times, be not so good at...emulating, that is, not do its job perfectly leading to lags and unexpected interrupts.

Are they legal?

Most companies don't mind letting you emulate their operating system, console environment or any other product, as long as you have the license for it and are not using it for commercial purpose. Some, including Nintendo,



An in-browser online service, Mymmo, lets you run different version of Android for different screen sizes

strictly prohibit use of their ROMs (a type of chip used in video game cartridges which contain the game software.) on the grounds of copyright violation. The rule varies across jurisdictions.

In short, emulators are perfectly legal. You can make an emulator yourself that emulates a specific console on another computer. Most companies, however, assert that one shouldn't use the same lines of code as used in the original software. The real problem is with ROM image files. Strictly speaking, they're illegal, and therefore you shouldn't download/upload them or make them available to anyone for download. Some companies insist that you can't download the ROM of a game even if you've purchased an original copy of it.